



Asimov can relate

Isaac Asimov's first editorial for his own Sci-Fi publication 'Asimov's Science Fiction' <http://dgit.in/asimovsyfy>

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Tales from the Void

Kit nodded.

"Why?"

He sat down on the curb. The dozens of scars that cut into his visage became more prominent as the weariness set in, making the twenty-two-year-old look at least a decade beyond his years.

And was it surprising that he looked the way he did? The misplaced Thoraxian War had taken a toll on all the human settlers on the planet. Kit was a 4th Genger. He had known no place other than Quatro Prime as his home. The war had force-drafted hundreds, killed thousands and left the rest of his race homeless and scattered across the massive planet. Kit had been one of the few surviving drafted who had been lucky enough to be scattered.

The Event had dissipated the war. Eight months into the bloodbath, when the sun winked out of existence and the rest of the stars followed suit, both sides dropped their weapons where they stood and backed off in pitch darkness. When the planet had entered Rapture. An era of darkness that had covered the planet for 13 months straight. Just when everyone had given up hope of ever seeing again, a dim light spread across the land, slowly growing brighter. The two orbs in the night sky mildly illuminated the planet, giving it enough light to survive and go on. Any expeditions made to these satellites were unsuccessful. Space above the planet's stratosphere seemed to have undergone some kind of metamorphosis, corroding almost any material it came into contact with. Kit had been on one such sip. He had been lucky to get him and his crew back to



the surface safely. It had also cost him his job with the Astronomer's church, but Kit was fine keeping his body firmly planted on the ground.

Kit snapped out of his reverie. He looked at Ka'Dor and sighed. "I apologize for the rough treatment. But I couldn't take a chance." He looked away respectfully "You can put yourself together, now. You may be more comfortable."

The Foraxian was still for a few seconds, then with a whirl of gyres and hiss of metal, its body pulled at its parts. polycarbonate tendons pulled metallic limbs together as nanobots buffed out the chips and scratches. The cables hanging from her severed neck crept down the bike and pulled her head into place with the rest of her body. In a few minutes, Ka'Dor stood up, flexing her body, testing the repair. Kit turned back to look at her. She looked at him with a steady gaze.

"You know too much about us, human. Who are you?"

Kit raised the sleeve of his trench coat to reveal an odd tattoo on his lower arm. Ka'Dor reeled back, stunned. If she was capable of emotion, the shock on her face would have made Kit snigger. The tattoo glistened silver, as if made out of some kind of alloy. In incredible detail, the design was in the shape of a crescent moon, entwined in the boughs of a banyan tree.

"Impossible!"

Kit smiled, as the tattoo vanished under his sleeve once more.

"But you are human!"

"Yes, and I am a part of the Order. One of the few that your Sovereign trusted to bring into his fold."

Ka'Dor began to bow, as a reflex. Kit raised his hand. "Enough of that. I respect your customs, but I am not your master." He stood up and dusted his clothes. "I do need your help, though."

"How can I help you?"

"I need you to guide me to the children of the moon."

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